

THE PARTY LEADER LESSON • LESSON 6 OF 6

Lead Your AI Squad



45 minutes, no prep. The hook: an AI agent does a whole job, step by step, on its own — and if your card leaves something out, the agent usually fills the gap with a guess and keeps going.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Run the Quest worksheet (3 pages; typeable PDF included) · Slides (optional) · scrap paper (1 per student) · board · Teacher Guide	None — unplugged. Optional: projector; your AI account (with-devices block, p.2)	Print worksheets. Plan teams of 3. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Write a four-part **quest card** an agent can't misread. (*Step 2; Exit #1*)
- Do one **squad role** (planner, scout, critic) silently — no questions asked. (*Step 3; Exit #2*)
- Review work with the **CHECK rubric**; write a specific run-it-back note. (*Step 4; Exit #3*)

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.7.c

CCSS ELA W.6.4

✓ WARM-UP — IT DID EXACTLY WHAT YOU SAID (6 MIN)

Your new party member: maxed stats, never sleeps, never complains — painfully literal. Last night's run:

"Guard the door." → Guarded the door. Only the door. The enemies came in through the window.

"Grab everything in the chest." → Everything. Including the cursed amulet with the obvious skull on it.

"Wait here." → Still waiting. It has been three in-game days.

Then ask: **whose fault was that — the party member's, or the orders?**

Bridge: "An AI agent does a whole job, step by step, on its own — and if your card leaves something out, the agent usually fills the gap with a guess and keeps going. That's why the leader checks. You'll never out-work it. You CAN out-lead it."

What if nobody laughs? Take a fourth order from the room and ruin it too: "Heal me" → healed you. Once.

Transition: "Today you learn the leader's loop: quest card, roles, check the loot — ship it or run it back."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THE PARTY LEADER'S LOOP (9 MIN)

Board: **QUEST CARD** → **ROLES** → **CHECK THE LOOT** → **SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK**.

QUEST CARD — four parts, in writing: **goal** (what winning means), **what we know** (who it's for, what the team has), **rules of the run** (length, tone, deadline), **done looks like** (the exact thing handed back). (If your class did the genie lesson: this is P.R.O. grown up.)

ROLES — nobody solos the raid: a **planner**, a **scout**, a **critic** — same card, one slice each.

CHECK THE LOOT — **accuracy** (facts match the card; every ✓ has a "how we know"), **taste** (fits the audience and tone — or could it be for anyone at all?), **done-ness** (everything the card asked for?). Weak work gets a run-it-back note: keep + fix.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION (CONT.)

Watch one get fixed — build it on the board, part by part. Cursed order: "Plan the game night." → **Party leader's quest card**: "GOAL: get 6th graders to actually show up to Game Night. WHAT WE KNOW: Friday, gym, 6–8 pm; we have board games and two TVs. RULES OF THE RUN: school-appropriate, big readable title, 40 words max. DONE LOOKS LIKE: one flyer draft, ready to photocopy." Then: "**Party leaders don't do the quest twice. If you redo a party member's work, your quest card failed — fix the card.**"

What if "too long"? Count it — four lines. "Four lines now, or 'games all night' on the flyer later."

Hand-out: "Page 1. Teams of 3. Pick your quest. ONE card per team: the card-holder writes all four parts, everyone copies GOAL and DONE LOOKS LIKE. Eight minutes."

ACTIVITY — RUN THE QUEST (24 MIN)

1. **Write the quest card (8 min)**: teams of 3 pick a quest — Game Night page or class magazine, issue #1 — and write ONE card. Only the card-holder writes all four parts; the other two copy GOAL and DONE LOOKS LIKE.

What if a team stalls on GOAL? "What would make you say we won?"

Switch: "Cards done. For 8 minutes YOU play an AI agent. Take a role card. Silence starts now."

2. **Squad works (8 min)**: each teammate takes a role card and works silently on scrap paper; papers never move mid-round. At the 4-minute call: "Critics, read your Planner's list over their shoulder — 3 upgrades. Planners, add a time guess to every step and star the one most likely to go wrong."

What if the class doesn't divide by 3? Team of 4: two critics. Team of 2: no critic; leader checks taste.

Swap: "Time. Sit in a triangle. The Scout sits on the Planner's left; the Critic sits on the Scout's left. Every paper moves one seat to its owner's left — the Planner's plan goes to the Scout, the Scout's questions go to the Critic, the Critic's list goes to the Planner. Keep your worksheet — you're the leader again, page 2."

3. **Leader review (8 min)**: each leader runs the CHECK rubric (worksheet p.2) on the paper in their hands, marks SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK per row, quotes ONE line of evidence for the row they mark RUN IT BACK, and writes KEEP and FIX. Last 60 seconds: "Hand the paper back and read your FIX line to its owner." Leave the rubric slide up (or write the three checks on the board).

What if a leader turns harsh? KEEP before FIX, and they read the note aloud to their party member.

Into the exit ticket: "Loot checked. Last quest: one for your own life. Page 3, solo."

EXIT TICKET (6 MIN)

Worksheet p.3, solo: #1 a quest card for a **real task in their own life**; #2 which role gets it first, and why; #3 the check it would most likely fail, and what to look for. Collect; key: Teacher Guide, p.3.

What if a student writes a wish ("help me with math")? "Which part would stop a stranger guessing? Add it."

DIFFERENTIATION

Support: sentence starters (Teacher Guide, p.1). **ELL**: draft in the strongest language first, then translate.

Extension: a card so tight the critic can't land a note. **No devices**: built in.

With devices (optional — teacher's projected account only; students never log in):

1. **Paste** a team's card word for word. Add: "Do the planner's job, then the scout's."
2. **Review** it as a class with the CHECK rubric — SHIP IT or RUN IT BACK per check.
3. **Watch for** an invented fact ("games all night"), a skipped rule, an extra step.
4. **Fix the card, not the output**: add the missing rule, run it again, compare.
5. **Time**: 6–8 min. Swap in for one team's Leader review, or open day 2 with it.